

Spring Water Quality Survey

Alder Creek Field Station · Reach 4 · March 2026

Summary

Five monitoring sites were visited over three days in March. Dissolved oxygen remained above the 6.0 mg/L threshold at every site, and pH stayed within the range the station has recorded since monitoring began. Conductivity at the culvert outflow is the one reading worth returning to: it has risen in each of the last four surveys and is now the highest on the reach.

Method

Readings are taken mid-channel at two thirds depth, upstream of the observer, with the probe allowed to settle for sixty seconds before the value is recorded. Where flow is too shallow for the probe, a grab sample is taken and measured on the bank within ten minutes. Every instrument is checked against buffer standards on the morning of a survey and again on return.

Readings

Site	Location	Date	pH	DO mg/L	Cond. uS/cm
AC-01	Upper meadow	12 Mar	7.1	9.4	142
AC-02	Culvert outflow	12 Mar	6.8	8.1	168
AC-03	Beaver pond	13 Mar	7.4	6.2	121
AC-04	Willow bend	13 Mar	7.2	8.8	134
AC-05	Lower gauge	14 Mar	6.9	9.1	155

Notes on the culvert outflow

Conductivity at AC-02 has risen from 121 to 168 microsiemens over four surveys. The culvert drains the lane and the verge above it, and the rise is consistent with road salt still working through after the winter. The reading is not itself a concern at this level; the trend is what the next survey should settle.

Observations by site

AC-01 — Upper meadow

Visited 12 Mar. pH 7.1, dissolved oxygen 9.4 mg/L, conductivity 142 microsiemens per centimetre. Channel clear, no odour, no visible film. Bank vegetation intact and the gauge board legible from the near bank.

AC-02 — Culvert outflow

Visited 12 Mar. pH 6.8, dissolved oxygen 8.1 mg/L, conductivity 168 microsiemens per centimetre. Channel clear, no odour, no visible film. Bank vegetation intact and the gauge board legible from the near bank.

AC-03 — Beaver pond

Visited 13 Mar. pH 7.4, dissolved oxygen 6.2 mg/L, conductivity 121 microsiemens per centimetre. Channel clear, no odour, no visible film. Bank vegetation intact and the gauge board legible from the near bank.

AC-04 — Willow bend

Visited 13 Mar. pH 7.2, dissolved oxygen 8.8 mg/L, conductivity 134 microsiemens per centimetre. Channel clear, no odour, no visible film. Bank vegetation intact and the gauge board legible from the near bank.

AC-05 — Lower gauge

Visited 14 Mar. pH 6.9, dissolved oxygen 9.1 mg/L, conductivity 155 microsiemens per centimetre. Channel clear, no odour, no visible film. Bank vegetation intact and the gauge board legible from the near bank.

Recommendations

Continue the four-weekly cycle through the summer. Add a second reading above the culvert so the rise at AC-02 can be attributed rather than inferred. Replace the gauge board at AC-05, which is legible but weathered.